Section 5(f). Prescription Drug Benefits

Important things you should keep in mind about these benefits:

- We cover prescribed drugs and medication, as described in this section.
- Please remember that all benefits are subject to the definitions, limitations, and exclusions in this brochure and are payable only when we determine they are medically necessary.
- Members must make sure their prescribers obtain prior approval/authorizations for certain prescription drugs and supplies before coverage applies. Prior approval/authorizations must be renewed periodically.
- Federal Law prohibits the return of prescription medications. Medication cannot be returned to dispensing pharmacies, and you will be responsible for the cost. Be sure to check the cost of your medication before filling the prescription.
- There is no calendar year deductible for prescription drugs processed under the prescription benefit. Copayments and coinsurance for prescription drugs go toward the annual out-of-pocket limit except for the difference between the cost of the generic and brand name medication.
- The non-PPO benefits are the standard benefits of this Plan. PPO benefits apply only when you use a PPO provider. When no PPO provider is available, non-PPO benefits apply.
- Be sure to read Section 4, *Your Costs for Covered Services*, for valuable information about how cost-sharing works. Also, read Section 9, *Coordinating Benefits with Medicare and Other Coverage,* for information about how we pay if you have other coverage, or if you are age 65 or over.
- **The exclusion for hormone treatments for Sex-Trait Modification for gender dysphoria** only pertains to chemical and surgical modification of an individual's sex traits (including as part of "gender transition" services). **We do not exclude coverage for entire classes of pharmaceuticals**, e.g., GnRH agonists may be prescribed during IVF, for reduction of endometriosis or fibroids, and for cancer treatment or prostate cancer/ tumor growth prevention.

There are important features you should be aware of. These include:

- **How to obtain preauthorization:** If you are filling a medication requiring a preauthorization for medical necessity, please call 855-240-0536.
- **Your plan participates in the Exclusive Choice Pharmacy Network.** All prescriptions need to be purchased through a participating network retail pharmacy. **Out-of-network claims are not eligible for benefits.**
- **Drug coupon/copay cards:** We do not coordinate benefits with drug coupon/copay cards.
- **Who can write your prescription:** A licensed physician or dentist, and in states allowing it, licensed or certified providers with prescriptive authority prescribing within their scope of practice.
- **Where you can obtain them:** You may fill the prescription at a participating network retail pharmacy or for Elevate Plus Option members, CVS Caremark Mail Service Pharmacy. CVS Specialty Pharmacy is the exclusive provider for specialty medications. You may contact the Specialty Pharmacy at 800-237-2767.
- **We have a managed formulary.** If your physician believes a name brand product is necessary or there is no generic available, your physician may prescribe a name brand drug from a formulary list. This list of name brand drugs is a preferred list of drugs that we selected to meet patient needs at a lower cost.
  - **Please see our online formulary and drug pricing search tools at the following** geha.com/Prescriptions-Summary.
- **These are the dispensing limitations.**
  - We use a formulary drug list that excludes coverage for certain medications unless we determine they are medically necessary. Refer to geha.com/Prescriptions-Summary for a list of drugs that require preauthorization for medical necessity.
  - CVS Specialty Pharmacy is the exclusive provider for specialty medications. You may contact the Specialty Pharmacy at 800-237-2767.